

Chapter 40-2: Transferring Energy

She didn't know how much time had passed before Chu Qingqiu finally opened her eyes. She seemed to wake from a nightmare, breathing heavily, suddenly gripping Ning Fuyi's sleeve tightly. Both Ning Fuyi's arm and spirit trembled, cutting off the flow of immortal energy.

The hand gripping her sleeve was white as jade stained with crimson blood, like broken mutton-fat jade¹.

After seeing Ning Fuyi's face clearly, her breathing gradually weakened. Her hand loosened and fell softly onto her own knee.

"What about that demon clan member?" she asked in a low voice.

"I don't know where he went," Ning Fuyi replied softly. "There's no trace of his aura nearby. He must have been injured and left the Divine Meteorite."

"I'll take you out," Looking at Chu Qingqiu in this state, Ning Fuyi said again. She didn't realize her voice had become gentle.

"Out?" Chu Qingqiu said. She struggled to lift her chin. Ning Fuyi looked in the direction she was gazing and her eyelashes fluttered slightly.

The divine sword put forth even more earnest effort to emit light. The originally fairly intact Divine Meteorite had disappeared, leaving only void as black as death around them, and the ground of the divine hall where they stood.

"He escaped, and the Divine Meteorite was destroyed," Chu Qingqiu said, her voice indescribably ethereal. "We can't get out."

Can't get out? Ning Fuyi quietly looked at the void around them. After a long while without speaking, she ignored Chu Qingqiu's objections and forcibly lifted her horizontally, walking toward the ruins.

"Let me go..."

"I don't believe it," Ning Fuyi interrupted her words. The young woman's eyes, like black obsidian, reflected the light of the divine sword. "As long as we're still alive, we can definitely get out."

Chu Qingqiu was too weak to struggle free. She only turned her head away, not looking at Ning Fuyi's face, saying coldly:

"I told you to leave. Why did you rush in? Don't you dislike me? Usually when you look at me, your eyes are full of resentment. Why save me now?"

She actually sensed it? Ning Fuyi was stunned, then blurted out: "Then why did you save me?"

Chu Qingqiu's words were blocked in her mouth.

They were silent for a while, then Ning Fuyi asked again: "Do you know who that demon clan member was? Why did he want to kill me, and why did he seem familiar with you?"

"Moreover, when I looked at him, I felt he was familiar, but I couldn't remember where I'd seen him." After a pause, Ning Fuyi added.

"I also don't know who he is," Chu Qingqiu said. "But since you feel he's familiar, you should pay more attention when facing people around you in the future."

Ning Fuyi hummed in agreement, but didn't understand how much truth there was in Chu Qingqiu's words.

Neither of them spoke again, and Chu Qingqiu didn't struggle either, allowing herself to be carried, stepping over a chaotic stairway toward the depths of the ruins.

The divine sword kept following behind them, dutifully serving as an oil lamp. Chu Qingqiu glanced at the divine sword once. Though surprised, she said nothing.

Since Chu Qingqiu was quite tall, she kept sliding down as she was carried. Ning Fuyi used her knee to nudge Chu Qingqiu upward so she could hold her more securely.

Chu Qingqiu suddenly closed her eyes, her cheeks flushing red in the darkness.

Walking up the steps of the divine hall, there was a partially collapsed archway. Ning Fuyi bent down to pass through it. Ahead was still a field of ruins, but in those ruins there seemed to be two human figures. Her steps immediately stopped.

Before she could speak, the divine sword flew up and illuminated the so-called "figures."

They were actually two corpses, already reduced to skeletons. From their appearance, they had been buried in this Divine Meteorite for ten thousand years, but the clothes on their bodies were still intact. One wore magnificent robes and brocade, with some jewelry scattered among the bones, showing their former splendor.

The other wore black armor. The two were face-to-face, sitting opposite each other in a strange posture.

"Could these be the masters of the Divine Meteorite?" Ning Fuyi said in surprise. She walked forward and bent down to place Chu Qingqiu on the ground.

The world only knew that the Divine Meteorite was where ancient gods had fallen, but didn't know why they had fallen. Ning Fuyi walked forward and reached out to touch the smooth tops of their heads.

"Ning Fuyi!" Chu Qingqiu immediately scolded. "You must not be disrespectful!"

Ning Fuyi thought to herself that they were already dead, and even they themselves were about to die—what was there to respect? But she still lowered her hand.

"This one in armor is from the demon clan," she pointed to the skeleton on the right. "The other must be the master of this Divine Meteorite. They must have killed each other and perished together."

"How do you know they killed each other?" Chu Qingqiu snorted lightly.

"Why else?" Ning Fuyi's phoenix eyes revealed mockery. "Gods and demons have always been this way. You, the mighty Chu Ling Divine Venerable, would naturally exterminate demons when you encounter them."

"Presumptuous," Chu Qingqiu said coldly, her voice extremely low. Ning Fuyi didn't hear clearly.

Ning Fuyi couldn't find any other clues, so she went forward to explore on her own, only to discover that behind this place was all void—there was no longer any path.

Could it really be as Chu Qingqiu said, that the two of them could never get out?

Her heart felt somewhat heavy, but perhaps because she had just picked up her life, she unexpectedly wasn't too distressed. So she returned the same way, about to call Chu Qingqiu, only to discover that she had collapsed on the ground again.

Her heart immediately contracted. Her body transformed into a stream of light, landing beside Chu Qingqiu and lifting her up. However, the body in her arms was as soft as risen dough, impossible to straighten no matter how she tried to support her.

"Divine Venerable! Chu Qingqiu!" She called her name repeatedly. Chu Qingqiu's face was completely bloodless, her disheveled hair hanging loosely on her shoulders. The exposed skin was already as cold as ice, and she seemed to have no breath.

Once upon a time, she had wished for her death, but now those thoughts of wanting her dead seemed to have vanished. Seeing her like this, it felt as if something was about to be lost from her heart, making her so anxious she didn't know what to do.

She quickly sent in immortal energy, but after a long time it had no effect. In her panic, she remembered that when people died, their qi² and blood were both empty. So she supported Chu Qingqiu's neck, pressed their lips together, and lowered her head to transfer energy to her.

Footnotes:

¹ **Mutton-fat jade (羊脂玉)** - A type of high-quality white jade prized in Chinese culture for its pure, translucent appearance resembling solidified mutton fat.

² **Qi (气)** - The vital energy or life force that flows through all living beings according to traditional Chinese philosophy and medicine.